

Fishing

People fished in many ways. They waded into rivers and the sea to spear fish. They also used fish traps and hooks, and worked together using nets. This hunter is using a harpoon—a spear for catching fish.

Harpoon head

The pointed end of the harpoon was called the head, and it was often decorated with plant or bird shapes.

Spear thrower

This was a stick with a hook at one end to hold a spear. By throwing the spear using the thrower, the speed, distance, and power were increased.

Spear made from hazel wood

Spear throwing

The first spears were made for thrusting. They required the hunter to get close to an animal to wound it. This could be dangerous. Then people started making spears to throw. Some groups of people made spear throwers, so spears could be thrown even further.

What did they hunt?

Big animals, such as woolly rhinoceros, were dangerous to hunt. Some groups of people specialized in catching one type of animal, such as reindeer. Smaller animals, such as frogs and turtles, were easier to catch.

In the water

Early people caught fish and other animals in rivers and in the sea. Shellfish were collected on the coast. Fish could be dried, smoked, and stored, and provided a healthy diet.



Trees and bushes

Birds nesting in trees and bushes, such as pigeons and ptarmigans, were hunted. Squirrels were also caught.



Land

People hunted all kinds of land animals, including hares, bison, red deer, wild boar, and horses.

